THE BEST CLASSIC SHEPHERD'S PIE

February 9, 2019

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The Best Classic Shepherd's Pie – AKA Shepards Pie or Cottage Pie. Ground Beef (or lamb) with vegetables in a rich gravy, topped with cheesy mashed potatoes, and baked.

SHEPHERD'S PIE

So, this is how you spell it: Shepherd's Pie. But, from doing a quick google search, it came to my attention that TONS of people think it's Shepards Pie.

IRISH SHEPHERD'S PIE

Traditional Irish Shepherd's Pie would actually call for ground lamb. The difference between Shepherd's Pie and Cottage Pie is the meat. Cottage Pie uses ground beef, while Shepherd's Pie uses ground lamb.

I called this recipe Shepherd's Pie. But, I wrote the recipe so that you could use ground beef or ground lamb.

I typically use ground beef because it is widely available. But, for a special occasion, like St. Patricks day, I would use ground lamb.

HOW TO MAKE SHEPHERD'S PIE

(Note – The full printable recipe is at the bottom of this post)

- Sauté some chopped onions in olive oil.
- Add ground beef or ground lamb.

- Add dried parsley, dried thyme, dried rosemary, salt, and pepper.
- Stir and cook the meat mixture until the meat is browned.
- Add minced garlic and Worcestershire sauce.

- Cook the garlic for a minute.
- Add flour and tomato paste.

- Add beef broth, frozen mixed peas and carrots, and frozen corn kernels.
- Simmer the meat gravy until it is thick.

- Boil some peeled and chopped potatoes until they are soft.
- Drain the potatoes

- Add butter, half & half, parmesan cheese, garlic powder, salt, and pepper.
- Mash the potatoes until smooth.

- Pour the meat mixture into a casserole dish.
- Top it with the cheesy mashed potatoes.

- Bake until the meat is bubbling and the potatoes are golden.

EASY SHEPHERD'S PIE

Making the best Shepherd's Pie is not difficult. But, there are a few steps to it. You have to make the meat mixture, the mashed potatoes, assemble the casserole, and bake it.

I find that the easiest way to make this dish is to work ahead. You could make the beef or lamb mixture ahead of time. Or, you could make the mashed potatoes ahead of time.

You could also make the whole recipe ahead of time. Just assemble the casserole, cover the dish, and keep it in the refrigerator until you are ready to bake it. I find it is best to bake it within 3 days of preparing it.

When you are ready to bake it, take it out of the refrigerator for about 20 minutes before you need to bake it to let it start coming to room temperature. Uncover it, and bake.

WHAT TO SERVE WITH THE BEST SHEPHERD'S PIE

- Deviled Eggs
- Roasted Broccoli from Skinnytaste
- The Best Chocolate Chip Cookies

WATCH THE VIDEO FOR THE BEST CLASSIC SHEPHERD'S PIE BELOW.

Best Classic Shepherd's Pie Recipe

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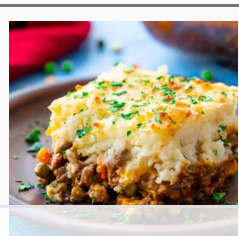

Prep Time	Cook Time	Total Time
20 minutes	50 minutes	1 hour 10 minutes

Servings: 6 servings Calories: 400kcal Author: Amanda Finks Print Recipe

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Ingredients

Meat Filling:

- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 cup chopped yellow onion
- 1 lb. 90% lean ground beef -or ground lamb
- 2 teaspoons dried parsley leaves
- 1 teaspoon dried rosemary leaves
- 1 teaspoon dried thyme leaves
- 1/2 teaspoon salt
- 1/2 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 1 tablespoon Worcestershire sauce
- 2 garlic cloves -minced
- 2 tablespoons all purpose flour
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 1 cup beef broth
- 1 cup frozen mixed peas & carrots*
- 1/2 cup frozen corn kernels

Potato Topping:

- 1 1/2 - 2 lb. russet potatoes -about 2 large potatoes peeled and cut into 1 inch cubes
- 8 tablespoons unsalted butter -1 stick
- 1/3 cup half & half
- 1/2 teaspoon garlic powder
- 1/2 teaspoon salt
- 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 1/4 cup parmesan cheese

Instructions

Make the Meat Filling.

1. Add the oil to a large skillet and place it over medium-high heat for 2 minutes. Add the onions. Cook 5 minutes, stirring occasionally.
2. Add the ground beef (or ground lamb) to the skillet and break it apart with a wooden spoon. Add the parsley, rosemary, thyme, salt, and and pepper. Stir well. Cook for 6-8 minutes, until the meat is browned, stirring occasionally.
3. Add the Worcestershire sauce and garlic. Stir to combine. Cook for 1 minute.
4. Add the flour and tomato paste. Stir until well incorporated and no clumps of tomato paste remain.
5. Add the broth, frozen peas and carrots, and frozen corn. Bring the liquid to a boil then reduce to simmer. Simmer for 5 minutes, stirring occasionally.
6. Set the meat mixture aside. Preheat oven to 400 degrees F.

Make the potato topping.

1. Place the potatoes in a large pot. Cover the potatoes with water. Bring the water to a boil. Reduce to a simmer. Cook until potatoes are fork tender, 10-15 minutes.

2. Drain the potatoes in a colander. Return the potatoes to the hot pot. Let the potatoes rest in the hot pot for 1 minute to evaporate any remaining liquid.
3. Add butter, half & half, garlic powder, salt, and pepper. Mash the potatoes and stir until all the ingredients are mixed together.
4. Add the parmesan cheese to the potatoes. Stir until well combined.

Assemble the casserole.

1. Pour the meat mixture into a 9x9 (or 7x11) inch baking dish. Spread it out into an even layer. Spoon the mashed potatoes on top of the meat. Carefully spread into an even layer.
2. If the baking dish looks very full, place it on a rimmed baking sheet so that the filling doesn't bubble over into your oven. Bake uncovered for 25-30 minutes. Cool for 15 minutes before serving.

Notes

*If you can't find frozen mixed peas and carrots, you could use 1/2 cup frozen peas and 1/2 cup frozen sliced carrots.

Nutrition

Serving: 1/6th of the recipe | Calories: 400kcal | Carbohydrates: 13g | Protein: 19g | Fat: 30g | Saturated Fat: 15g | Cholesterol: 97mg | Sodium: 751mg | Potassium: 483mg | Fiber: 2g | Sugar: 2g | Vitamin A: 2860IU | Vitamin C: 7.9mg | Calcium: 99mg | Iron: 2.7mg

Course Dinner, Entree, Main Course Cuisine American, Irish

Keyword Classic shepherd's pie, How to make shepherd's pie, Shepherd's Pie Recipe

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COMMENTS

Aisha says

August 11, 2020 at 7:06 AM

I really want to make this but don't have beef broth. What can i use instead, please?

REPLY

carol flowers says

August 31, 2020 at 6:25 PM

I used a beef packet from ramen noodle soup because so didn't have any beef broth.

REPLY

Cinnamon says

September 1, 2020 at 6:32 PM

You can use beef bouillon to make broth in a pinch. Just follow the directions on the jar.

REPLY

Lauren says

August 11, 2020 at 10:37 AM

Amazing recipe! I used more potatoes than the recipe called for and I brushed an egg wash on the potatoes before putting them in the oven. This recipe was so delicious and the best shepherds pie I've ever eaten

REPLY

Natalja Cormier says

August 12, 2020 at 2:53 PM

Love this recipe 👍👍👍👍 Thank you so much❤

REPLY

Cathy says

August 12, 2020 at 3:36 PM

This is the best shepherds pie I have ever made. Omitted Worcestershire sauce because I didn't have any. And I used a can of corn because my kids are not big fans of peas and carrots. Subbed milk instead of half and half in the potatoes because I didn't have any And may have added some extra parm cheese cause it's delicious!

REPLY

Lidia says

August 15, 2020 at 4:28 PM

This is my the third time doing this recipe. My family loved and each time gets easier and tastier. I added two egg yolks to the mash potatoes. Thanks

REPLY

Ingrid says

August 18, 2020 at 7:18 AM

The whole family loved this recipe. I had to substitute a few ingredients because I don't use milk or butter. I used ground turkey and use usually more seasonings because of that. I will for sure make this also in a vegan version for my husband with the Vegetarian Better than Bouillon No Beef Base. I have used this Bouillon also in the Recipe with the ground turkey which gave it a deeper flavor. Thank you for this great recipe!

REPLY

Kenneth McEwen says

August 22, 2020 at 11:20 AM

this recipe sounds amazing i have no 1/2&1/2 cream what can i do ?

REPLY

Rhonda says

August 24, 2020 at 6:37 PM

My family wants this every week. Delicious!

REPLY

Patrick says

August 25, 2020 at 5:18 PM

I subbed out beef for beyond meat and beef broth for veggie broth and used vegan butter to make this recipe animal free and it was so so so good. Wow. Must try, even for people who eat animals.

REPLY

sof says

August 25, 2020 at 5:31 PM

such a great recipe to get the right texture but is say go easy on the rosemary….it's a very strong flavor and it really over powers the rest

REPLY

Amy says

August 29, 2020 at 4:46 PM

So delicious! Made with ground chicken and it was amazing.

REPLY

Julie says

August 31, 2020 at 7:34 AM

This was so good! I made it as it's written and it will be my go-to Shepherd's Pie recipe from now on. My husband loves Shepherd's Pie (he's 1/4 Irish) and he practically licked the plate! Thank you!

REPLY

Audrey S Hopkins says

August 31, 2020 at 8:21 PM

I roasted califlower in the oven since we are cutting carbs. I tossed a large head (broken up) with a quarter cup olive oil, the garlic powder and salt and pepper in amount from the recipe. I pureed that in my Nutribullet with the butter and used whipping cream. I sprinkled the parmesean on top. Other than that I followed the recipe exactly except for the Thyme. I used ground Thyme and having read an earlier post, I used half a tsp.

REPLY

Susan says

September 1, 2020 at 12:32 AM

Excellent Shepherd's Pie recipe. My family and I loved it. It's the best recipe for Sheperd's Pie and it's really delicious.

REPLY

Nancy Hanners says

September 2, 2020 at 8:23 PM

Outstanding No leftovers my first time cooking it!

REPLY

Dustin says

September 7, 2020 at 5:33 AM

Tips: if you've never used Worcestershire sauce use just a very little amount until you know if you like it or not

If you don't want to go through the hassle of making mashed potatoes, cook instant potatoes such as Idahoian instead.
I used garlic baby reds and some potatoes.

Corn and green beans can be used for your vegetables as those are more universally liked vegetables compared to peas.

REPLY

Lee Ann Andrews says

September 7, 2020 at 9:59 PM

Was wondering if it could be frozen. I'm trying to make dinners for my mother-in-law so she can heat & eat dinners ready since she can't cook anymore

REPLY

Elissa Talley says

September 7, 2020 at 11:01 PM

This was so fun to cook. I was easy as well. Thank you my family really loved it!

REPLY

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bring you the BEST recipes your whole family will love! See More.

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